

Houseplant care guide

A quick-reference summary for watering, light, pruning, seasonal adjustments, and what to avoid.

Korean Rock Fern *Polystichum tsus-simense*

FERN

WATERING	Keep the soil consistently moist but not waterlogged. Let the top inch dry slightly between waterings, but never let it dry out completely – ferns are unforgiving about drought.
LIGHT	Bright, indirect light or partial shade. Avoid direct sun, which will scorch the fronds.
PRUNING	Snip off brown or dead fronds at the base to keep the plant tidy and redirect energy into new growth.
SEASONAL	In winter, water slightly less but keep humidity up – central heating dries the air considerably.
DISLIKES	Dry air, direct sun, cold draughts, and sitting right next to radiators or heating vents.

Heart-Leaf Philodendron *Philodendron hederaceum*

TRAILING

WATERING	Water when the top 2–3 cm of soil feels dry. If unsure, err on the dry side – it tolerates light neglect far better than overwatering.
LIGHT	Bright, indirect light is ideal. It will survive in lower light but growth will be slower and less leafy.
PRUNING	Trim back long, leggy vines to encourage bushier growth. Cuttings root easily in water if you want more plants.
SEASONAL	Reduce watering frequency in winter, as growth slows and soil stays damp for longer.
DISLIKES	Direct sun (leaf scorch/bleaching), cold draughts, and waterlogged soil – root rot is its most common killer.

Crassula ovata (Jade Plant) *Crassula ovata*

SUCCULENT

WATERING	Water deeply, then let the soil dry out completely before watering again. This is the plant most likely to suffer from overwatering.
LIGHT	Bright light, ideally with a few hours of direct sun. Very intense afternoon sun through glass can occasionally scorch leaves, so watch for that.
PRUNING	Pinch growing tips to encourage a bushier, more tree-like shape. Tolerates being cut back well.
SEASONAL	Semi-dormant in winter – water only about once a month and keep somewhere cool but frost-free. A sheltered, sunny spot outdoors in summer is a bonus, but bring it in before the cold sets in.
DISLIKES	Cold and frost (can cause mushy, blackened leaves), and cold, wet soil in winter.

Cylindrical Snake Plant *Sansevieria cylindrica*

SUCCULENT

WATERING	Very low needs – let the soil dry out fully between waterings, roughly every 2–3 weeks (less in winter). Overwatering and root rot are by far its biggest risks.
LIGHT	Prefers bright, indirect light but tolerates low light well. Long periods of direct sun can occasionally cause bleaching.
PRUNING	Minimal – just remove any damaged or mushy leaves at the base.
SEASONAL	Cut watering back further in winter, when the plant is essentially dormant.
DISLIKES	Cold draughts and temperatures below about 10°C, as well as overwatering.

Keeping Coriander (Cilantro) Alive *Coriandrum sativum*

HERB

Coriander has a reputation for dying quickly, but this is mostly down to its biology rather than anything you're doing wrong:

SOW DIRECT	Coriander has a long taproot and resents being transplanted. Sow seeds directly into their final pot rather than moving seedlings.
KEEP IT COOL	Heat and stress cause it to bolt (run to seed) quickly. A bright spot out of intense midday sun, especially in summer, helps slow this down.
WATER	Avoid letting the pot dry out completely – inconsistent watering is another common trigger for bolting.
SUCCESSION SOW	Individual plants don't last long before bolting, so sow a new batch every 2–3 weeks for a continuous supply.
HARVEST	Snip outer leaves little and often rather than stripping the whole plant – this also helps delay bolting.
LET IT SEED	If it does bolt and flower, the seeds it produces are coriander spice – and great for starting your next batch.

Compiled for general reference – your home's light, humidity and central heating may need some adjustment.

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